

The Dhāraṇī of the King of Lunar Days, Constellations, and Moments

Toh 793 · Derge Kangyur

ཆེ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་མོ་དང་། རྩ་སྐྱེ་དང་། ཡད་ཅམ་གཉིས་པུ་ལོ།

This short text, which the Tibetan opening line presents as homage to the Blessed One who is the king of lunar days, constellations, and moments, can be rendered in English as something like "The Dhāraṇī of Auspicious Days and Constellations"; I am not certain of its exact Sanskrit and Tibetan titles, since the source lines given here show only the opening homage rather than a formal title. It is a brief dhāraṇī text, consisting of a homage to the Three Jewels and to a Tathāgata associated with the calendar's lunar days, constellations, and moments, followed by a mantra and simple instructions for its use. The practice is to recite the mantra seven times before setting out in any chosen direction, so that all one's aims will be accomplished, which places it among the protective and auspicious-timing texts concerned with safe and successful travel. It is Toh 793 in the Kangyur, belonging to the Tantra section and, more specifically, to the class of dhāraṇī texts.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, the king of lunar days, of the constellations, and of the moments.

Tadyathā: nakṣatre, sarvatithīmūrte, nakṣatrani, mesamitadhani, bhavantu svāhā.

As for its procedure: whichever direction one wishes to travel in, one recites this seven times and then sets out, and all one's aims will be accomplished.

The dhāraṇī for the accomplishment of all aims is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit of the dhāraṇī is given in the Tibetan transliteration, and its reconstruction is uncertain in places. I have reproduced it as closely as the Tibetan allows, and it should be treated as a phonetic rendering to be recited rather than translated. The phrase "lunar days, constellations, and moments" refers to the astrological divisions of time, namely the tithis, the nakṣatras, and the muhūrtas, over which the Tathāgata is here praised as sovereign.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.